FIN-003 · Personal finance

Emergency fund planner

Replace the sample figures before you rely on the result.

An emergency fund is cash for a shock, not a holiday account. The sample essential month is rent, a reduced grocery bill, work transport, medical aid, electricity, and a small mobile cost. Discretionary spending is left out on purpose.

How to use the workbook

1. Delete any essential you would not keep paying, or set it to zero.
2. Choose the number of months. Three is the sample. One month is a valid first target if three is out of reach.
3. Enter cash you can withdraw quickly. A 32-day notice account is not the same as money available today.
4. Read Months to target. If it is longer than you can accept, raise the contribution or lower the month count. Do not invent a higher income.

Worked example

Sample essentials total R17,800 a month.

- Three months is a R53,400 target.
- R8,000 is already saved, so R45,400 remains.
- At R2,000 a month the estimate is 22.7 months.

A practical routine

- Keep the fund in an account you do not use for groceries.
- After you use it, the next budget's job is to refill it.
- Review the essential list when rent or medical aid changes.

This workbook organises figures you type in. It is not financial, credit, insurance, or tax advice. Rates, fees, and laws change. A qualified adviser should review decisions that affect debt, tax, medical cover, or retirement.